

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

## ALT this month:

Start off with a quick guide to the most popular cinema filming formats, some being championed by leading filmmakers of today. Then dive straight into the history of amateur radio. Once you're done with that, prepare yourself for a trip into imagination as we visualise what nuclear fallouts in the top Indian cities would be like, before re-imagining a classic short story with a futuristic twist.



## Parrot befriends Alexa

A bad mouthed parrot has found a best friend in Alexa. The parrot, named Rocco, uses the smart speaker to play songs and order treats. The owner had to cancel orders for watermelons, strawberries, and ice cream.

<https://dgit.in/pollyalexa>

## WHAT'S NEW

# A patient coughed up this blood clot cast

**A** 36 year old heart patient was admitted to the intensive care unit of a hospital for a failing heart. He coughed up this blood clot, in its entirety. Doctors unravelled the ball of clotted blood, and realised that it was a cast of the right bronchial tree of the patient's lung. This is a blood clot that represents a network of tubes that ferries air to and from the lungs. The network of tubes was so well preserved in the blood clot, that the medical practitioners were able to recognise which part of the body it originated from just by looking at the structure of the tubes and their orientation. The doctors who treated the patient are not entirely sure how the blood clot survived in its entirety,



and was not broken down into smaller pieces. The patient had been coughing up small blood clots over a period of a few days. While extremely rare, this kind of thing has been documented to have happened before. In

1926, a patient coughed up a cast of the trachea with both the bronchi attached, and in 2005, another patient had coughed up a smaller bronchial tree cast.

<https://dgit.in/clotcast>

# Bear repellent accident at Amazon Warehouse

**A** robot at an Amazon Fulfillment Center in New Jersey accidentally punctured a can of bear repellent. The repellent is made up of capsaicin extract, which is what makes capsicums spicy. The repellent was exposed to the human workers at the warehouse, which caused 50 of them to fall sick, and 24 had to be hospitalised. This is not even the first time there has been a bear repellent accident at an Amazon workplace. Earlier



in 2018, in the same facility, an employee dropped a can and accidentally ruptured it, but there were no injuries. Back in 2015, a robot ran over a can of bear repellent at an Amazon facility

in Texas. While all the affected workers recovered, the incident is a demonstration of exactly how hazardous working for Amazon can really get, considering the warehouses can be full of all kinds of toxic things. Beyond that, distribution center walls have collapsed, roofs have been torn off by tornados, and trucks have run over people. Amazon tops the list of companies for unsafe labour practices in the US.

<https://dgit.in/amznhzrd>



## The Future of Entertainment

Technology is going to give entertainment a revamp, with AI crafting hits, dead celebs entertaining us through holograms, interactive TV that puts you in the heart of the action, and massive 360 degree screens peppered with directional speakers all around.

<https://dgit.in/entfut>



## Hacker pretends to kidnap baby

A hacker gave two parents a scare when he pretended to be in their baby's room and threatened to kidnap the baby. The hacker pulled the scare off by compromising the baby monitor, which was in the baby's room. The parents called the police, and threw away the baby monitor.

<https://dgit.in/babyhack>



## Teslas can now fart

Tesla's latest update allows the electric vehicles to fart on demand, or when taking a turn. There are six farting sounds, each named after things related to Elon Musk – such as the Falcon Heavy, the Boring Fart and the Ludicrous Fart. There's also a heating "Romance Mode" with mood music and a fireplace display.

<https://dgit.in/teslafarts>